

HRRP BULLETIN

9 July 2018



WATCH: Phulmaya Tamang, from Ward No. 2, Panuati Municipality, Kavre, shares "I did not feel that I wanted to rush reconstruction of my home, but we did need to rebuild our house. I heard in Kathmandu that if we didn't build our house within the month of Poush (December 2017 / January 2018) we would not be able to get citizenship certificates for our children so we built the house." Credit: Om Astha Rai / Nepali Times.



Ward no. 4, Uttargaya Rural Municipality, Rasuwa District: homeowner, Mr. Jit Bahadur Syangtang, has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant for this one room, one storey, load bearing stone and cement mortar masonry house. Financial support for the grant was provided by Lumanti Support Group for Shelter. Photo credit: Lumanti.



Ward No. 1, Kipsang Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: homeowner, Mr. Krishna Bahadur Tamang, has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and is working towards the third tranche. The house is one room and 1.5 storeys and is load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry.

Highlights

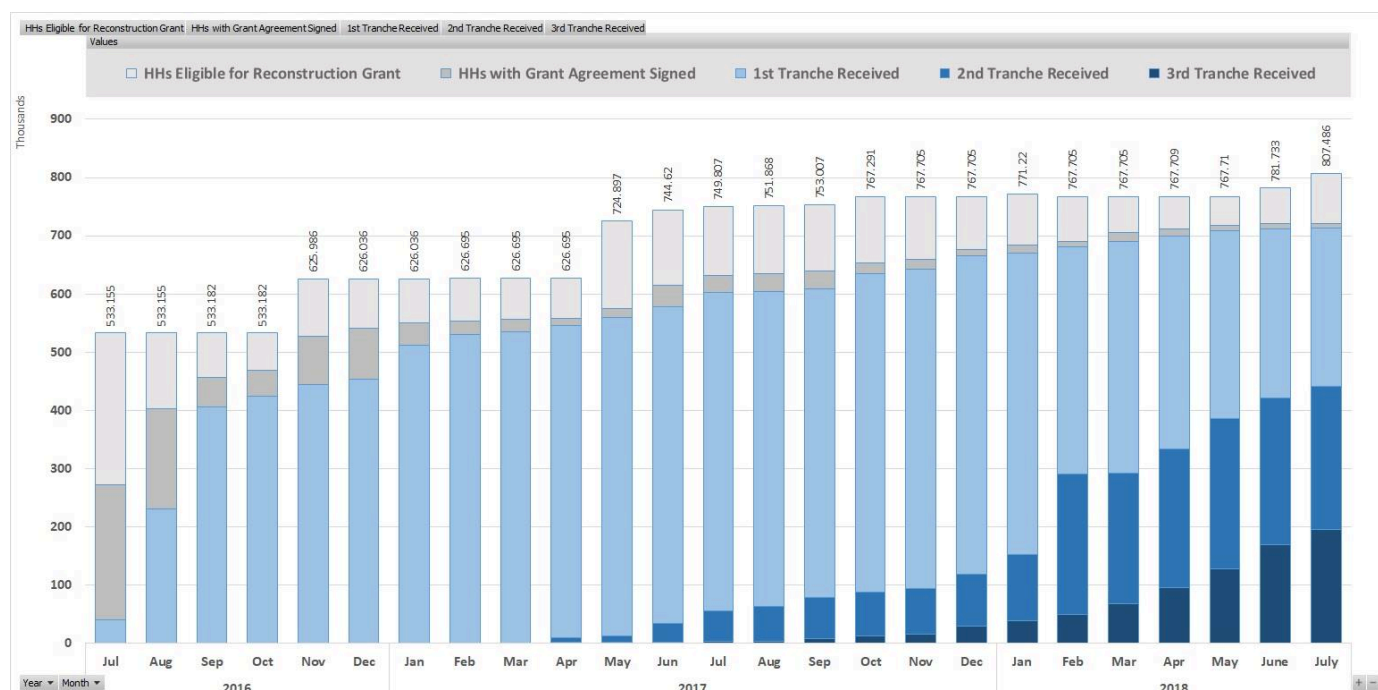
- The number of households eligible for the Government of Nepal (GoN) housing reconstruction grant has now passed 800,000 and the number of households eligible for the GoN housing retrofit grant has passed 50,000. The scale of the housing reconstruction is enormous and requires appropriate time and investment in socio-technical assistance if it is to be a success.
- [‘CEO Bhusal Bids NRA Goodbye’](#): Mr. Yuba Raj Bhusal was given a warm farewell at the NRA office in Singha Durbar on Sunday, 8 July. The government decided to relieve Mr. Bhusal from his post on 4 July.
- **Second Tranche Disbursement Deadline, 16 July** – HRRP advocates for the deadlines to be extended for at least the next two building seasons to allow a realistic period for households to complete their reconstruction.
- [‘Permission to support in the construction of houses for vulnerable households’](#): NRA announced approval of vulnerable support projects under four organisations; Mercy Corps, Care Nepal, People in Need, NRCS, and Practical Action. A [map of coverage of approved vulnerable support projects](#) (based on available details) has been prepared by HRRP.
- Training on Light Timber/Steel frame Structure Manual for engineers (GoN and POs), completed in Sindhuli on 5 and 6 July
- First meeting of Hollow Concrete Block Technical Working Group (HCB TWG) expected to take place this week – contact Kuber Bogati, National Technical Coordination Officer, techofficer1.national@hrrpnepal.org, if interested to participate
- [Summary of Vulnerable Support Working Group Meeting, 2 July](#)
- Transition from HRRP 4W to NRA 5W – HRRP 4W phased out as of 30 June. POs requested to report to NRA 5W (on 25th of every month). Please contact Uttam Paudel, im.manager@hrrpnepal.org, if you have any questions or need support.
- HRRP District Reports are now available on the HRRP website here: <http://hrrpnepal.org/resources-materials/district-reports->

UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

[NRA, CLPIU GMALI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 8 July:](#)

	10 June	24 June	8 July
Total No. Eligible HHs	775,149	781,733	807,486
HHs Enrolled	718,986	720,482	721,281
HHs Received 1st Tranche	710,329	711,988	712,943
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	449,802	463,780	475,619
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	406,546	421,341	441,307
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	189,408	210,931	243,440
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	138,324	169,526	195,657



Housing reconstruction progress based on MoFALD CLPIU enrolment data from July 2016 to 8 July 2018.

Second Tranche Disbursement Deadline, 16 July: it has been almost one year since the NRA first announced the tranche disbursement deadlines ([see HRRP Bulletin from 24 July 2017](#)) and there has been mounting evidence that the the deadline is causing trauma and stress for people trying to manage their housing reconstruction. The deadline is part of the reason for the large-scale borrowing at high interest rates that look set to cause a potential debt crisis. They are also the reason for people building small houses just to collect the grant. These houses do not meet people's living requirements and cannot represent a successful housing reconstruction. It is very positive that the numbers of households progressing with their construction is consistently increasing, but as of 8 July there are 611,829 households that need support to get to completion. This is not possible within the current deadlines. Experience from other post-disaster reconstruction efforts shows that approximately 5 years is required at least, and urban requires more time. HRRP advocates for the deadlines to be extended for at least the next two building seasons to allow a realistic period for households to complete their reconstruction.

Vulnerable Support Working Group Meeting, 2 July: this was the sixth meeting of the working group. The meeting started with a presentation from HRRP which included an update on proposal submission to NRA for vulnerable support, on the verification process of the NRA list of vulnerable households, and some considerations for the next

steps for the group. It was agreed that there should be a common strategy and approach to address the needs and gaps in an effective and efficient manner. The next steps for the group are development of a Terms of Reference (ToR) for the working group and expansion of the group with more diverse participation and expertise of social scientists, anthropologists, economists, etc. It is hoped that the next meeting of the group will take place this week and will include presentations from partners on experience providing vulnerable support to date. For more information, please contact Rupa Panday, HRRP MEAL Coordinator, meal@hrrpnepal.org, and Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP National Coordination Officer, minar@hrrpnepal.org.

Transition from HRRP 4W to NRA 5W: the HRRP 4W has been collecting data on activities being implemented by Partner Organisations (POs) in support of housing reconstruction. HRRP has been supporting NRA with the setup and roll out of the 5W data collection system. With the 5W now up and running for many months, it has been decided that the HRRP will phase out the 4W as of 30 June (i.e. end of this week). Reporting to the 5W is monthly, on the 25 of each month and POs are requested to submit their reports on 25 July. The HRRP IM team remain available to provide support on any issues related to progress reporting. Please contact Uttam Paudel, im.manager@hrrpnepal.org, if you have any questions or need support. There will also be a series of orientations, at district and national level, on this transition in the coming weeks.

Districts & Municipalities

Training on Light Timber/Steel frame Structure Manual, Sindhuli, 5-6 July: the training programme was organised for engineers (GoN and POs) working in Sindhuli, where there are the largest proportion of timber frame structures. The training was jointly organised by HRRP and CLPIU/DLPIU Buildings, with technical support from HRRP, NSET, JICA and ASF Nepal.



HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 25 June – 9 July: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Dhading (25 June) and Bhaktapur (6 July). Municipal level meetings took place in Lisankhupakhar Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok (28 June) and Manebhanjyang Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga (3 July). Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- **In Dhading,** all the Partner Organisations (POs) working at various locations were requested to support on the verification of the reconstruction status of the vulnerable households circulated by central NRA in coordination with Rural / Urban Municipalities and Wards. In Dhading, 97 out of 267 beneficiaries have been supported with the 200,000 NPRs grant from NRA/GMALI in coordination with CSRC and PIN. One of the issues in Damgade, Dhading is that beneficiaries here were relocated from Lapa and Ree. There is a

confusion if these people are eligible for two lakh relocation grants or not since they bought 1-4 aana of land on their own but the land is at risk of landslide and these beneficiaries are also listed in NRA.

- **In Bhaktapur**, mainly in Madhyapur Thimi, there has been increasing trend of illegal addition of storeys apart from the number being approved in the building permit. The additional storeys were mostly found in houses with 9"x9" and 9"x12" pillars and even in houses that were considered unsafe from structural analysis. In response, Madhyapur Thimi Municipality has been fining these households. Engineers have been receiving as early as possible inspection/observation request of houses in reconstruction phase from beneficiaries who intends to add storeys. Tranche claim of such houses are in pending stage. There have also been cases of selling and buying of the houses in reconstruction phase. According to GMALI Chief, property transfer of such case from the beneficiary to non-beneficiary is legally impossible. Such transactions will withdraw further grant approval processes of beneficiary and PA number cannot be transferred to the buyer. Beneficiaries who want to transfer from reconstruction to retrofitting and vice versa are increasing. Such beneficiaries have also not taken forward reconstruction process. For addressing cases of houses in retrofitting list, if such houses are referred to the central grievances remain in retrofitting list from the inspection by engineers, then such referral documents should be forward to central grievances committee at NRA, Singha Durbar. For solving cases of private houses that were later turned into commercial buildings, Municipality holds authority to forward control mechanisms to address such houses. Such cases cannot be solved by NRA DLPIU GMALI. Handling the issues of residential houses is only under the authority of DLPIU Building and GMALI. M & E Consultant, CLPIU NRA Building emphasized that houses that have received complete tranche cannot be considered as construction completed houses. If the houses that has successfully taken third tranche and claims for construction completion certificate, given the case of such houses have met minimum and basic requirements then Annex 16 & 17 should be filled. Such Annex 16 & 17 should be forwarded to Chief Administrative Officer of concerned municipality for verification. In order to take construction completion certificate, the houses must be as per the drawing and should align with the building permit. Engineers were informed to look after the files submitted till end of Ashad 2075 only.
- **In Lisankhupakhar RM, Sindhupalchok**, some of the issues raised were: closure of ward-5 office by the beneficiaries whose names have not been included in the beneficiary list. This has caused delay in processing the files by the engineers with approaching deadline. In ward-1, many of the houses have been missed to be included in the grievance list because the resurvey team were called back before they could cover all the areas of the ward. There is a rumor that resurvey would be conducted again. In some wards, beneficiaries have been in the retrofitting list though their houses are completely damaged. Ward representatives said it would have been convenient if the tranche is transferred directly to the concerned bank instead of transferring from one bank to another. A case of duplication in the PA number has been reported. Two people have the same PA number. Actual beneficiary has not received the tranche while the other not in the beneficiary list has got the tranche. It was also discussed that some people have been taking advantage of the new engineers, requesting them to inspect the houses that are not in their name. Sometimes, the engineers have reportedly been pressured by the beneficiaries to approve their houses. Rural Municipalities to assure the safety of the field engineers.
- **In Manebhanjyang RM, Okhaldhunga**, main issues raised during the meeting was the difference in PA number with corresponding names of beneficiaries from wards 6 and 9. Ward and municipal representatives will verify the list and sort out the problem in coordination with District GMALI MIS expert. If the problem cannot be solved at district level, the list with wrong PA numbers will be sent to the Central GMALI MIS. The municipality will also compile a list of all non-compliant houses and forward it to District GMALI. District GMALI will send the list to the DLPIU and DSE requesting these cases to be addressed within the week.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Weekly District Report, 22 June – 5 July 2018



Ward No. 5, Bidur Municipality, Nuwakot: a four-roomed hollow concrete block structure. The owner has received the second tranche of Government housing reconstruction grant and has been approved for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Okhaldhunga, Weekly District Report, 22 June – 5 July 2018



Ward No. 4, Molung Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga: a two-room, one storey plus attic, stone and mud mortar masonry house with RCC bands. The owner has received all three tranches of the Government of Nepal (GoN) housing reconstruction grant. Financial and technical support has been provided by NRCS.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Ramechhap, Weekly District Report, 22 June – 5 July 2018](#)



Ward No. 1, Ramechhap Municipality, Ramechhap: a stone and mud mortar masonry house with combined RCC and timber bands. The gable wall has been constructed using heavy materials with gable band. The attic height exceeds three-feet. The owner has received second tranche of Government housing reconstruction grant.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Rasuwa, Weekly District Report, 22 June – 5 July 2018](#)



Ward No. 5, Aamo Chhodingmo Rural Municipality, Rasuwa: three-room brick and cement mortar masonry with RCC bands and CGI roof. The owner has received the second tranche of the Government housing reconstruction grant. The house is L-shaped, and so non-compliant and has not been approved for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Weekly District Report, 22 June – 5 July 2018



Ward No. 6, Lisankhupakhar Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: a one-room house, constructed with stone and cement mortar masonry with flexible roof. The owner has received second tranche of Government housing reconstruction grant and the third tranche is on process.

Requests for Partner Support

Hollow Concrete Block Technical Working Group: during the meeting of the NRA technical committee on Thursday 7 June, the committee members endorsed the [HRRP report on production and use of Hollow Concrete Blocks \(HCBs\)](#), including the next steps. The first meeting of the technical working group to support with the development of guidelines for HCB producers, inspection checklists and minimum requirements for HCB construction, and options for corrections for non-compliant HCB construction is due to take place this week. Those interested to participate are requested to contact Kuber Bogati, National Technical Coordination Officer, techofficer1.national@hrrpnepal.org.

Call for Presentations for next '20x20 Partner Sharing Session', August: many thanks to the partners that presented at the first of these sessions on 14 June. Partners interested to present are requested to write to Ruplal Aidi, HRRP National Coordination Officer, nco2@hrrpnepal.org, to indicate their interest to present and what the proposed topic of the presentation is. N.B. this session will use the 'Pecha Kucha', 20 X 20 style of presentation. Each presentation will have 20 slides with 20 seconds allowed per slide, totaling 6 minutes and 40 seconds. The presentation is automated and therefore no additional time is possible.

8th International Conference on Building Resilience, November 14-16, Lisbon, Portugal

DOCUMENTS & PRODUCTS

Government of Nepal

[NRA Newsletter, June 2018](#)

HRRP

[Map of Coverage of Approved Partner Organisation Support for Vulnerable HHs Identified by the NRA – as of 9 July](#): this map has been prepared based on currently available data. Please contact Uttam Paudel, HRRP IM Manager, im.manager@hrrpnepal.org, if you have any updates to share regarding this map.

[Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps](#): based on MoUD CLPIU inspection data as of 22 June.

[Partnership Agreement between HHs and GoN](#)

[Construction Started](#)

[1st tranche received](#)

[Compliance rate 2nd tranche](#)

[Compliance rate 3rd tranche](#)

[Construction Completed](#)

Partners

[Milijuli Nepali, BBC Media Action, Episode 992](#): this episode was recorded in Gokulganga, Ramechhap. The presenter approaches three sisters who are sitting on the porch of their house having a conversation about family matters. The conversation soon transforms into a discussion on how the rebuilding of new homes is going on in their respective areas and what kind of measures are being adopted to ensure the new houses that are being built are earthquake safe. Details on a strong foundation, the process of building, the collection of tranches, and how family members can help each other build, are also part of the conversation. The episode also has another conversation with a homeowner on how to make wise use of water during reconstruction and the struggles around finding skilled masons.

[ASF Nepal Newsletter, Issue No. 19, June 2018](#)

[Learning and Sharing Workshop on ‘On the Job Training \(OJT\)’, Baliyo Ghar, Charikot, Dolakha, 5 July](#): the workshop, which was attended by the Mayor of Bhimeshwor Municipality, Mr. Bharat KC and NRA-Dolakha Chief, Mr. Nirmal Darsan Acharya, provided an opportunity to discuss the achievements, challenges faced, lessons learnt, and areas for improvement for OJT. The objective of the workshop was to determine how effective OJT has been in supporting the reconstruction process and to get input to support standardisation of curriculum development and development of a OJT implementation strategy. One major area of discussion was how to involve masons that have completed OJT training in reconstruction works, and how to retain them as masons even after reconstruction. Mr. Bharat KC urged reconstruction actors to look to the future and how to provide technical assistance after the reconstruction campaign is over. “There are chances of expanding the houses with annexes and adding the upper floors after the households receive the 3rd tranche of government grant, hence to ensure the safety of annexes and other structures, organizations like NSET should give serious consideration to how technical assistance can and should continue in the longer term”, Mr. KC said. The NSET Baliyo Ghar programme, through implementing partners Training Center Nepal Pvt. Ltd. (TCN) and Trade Link Pvt. Ltd are providing surge support for OJT in all wards of previous VDCs and municipalities in Dolakha, Dhading, and Nuwakot. This will result in a total of 4,000 new masons across the three districts.



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